

RYAN THOEMKE

651.270.8590

rthoemke@icloud.com

linkedin.com/in/ryanthoemke

GOLF & COMMUNITY

Grounds Crew Member

Hillcrest Country Club

St. Paul, MN | 2 Seasons

- Ground-level knowledge of private club operations, member culture, and course standards.
- Competitive league golfer — authentic perspective on what makes golf brands resonate.

Volunteer Coach

Special Olympics Minnesota

Adapted Softball & Floor Hockey

- Multi-season volunteer coach coordinating with community organizations and supporting participants across events.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Partnership & Relationship Mgmt
- Brand Activations & Events
- Merchandise Curation & Ordering
- Brand Standards & Identity
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Budget & P&L Ownership
- Vendor & Supplier Management
- Process Building from Scratch
- Stakeholder Communication

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Relationship-driven professional with a decade of experience building trust across customers, brand partners, and cross-functional teams. Lifelong golfer with firsthand experience in golf operations and a genuine connection to the culture and community the game creates. Proven track record of owning budgets, curating branded merchandise, producing brand activations, and launching initiatives from the ground up. Brings a service-first mindset and authentic enthusiasm for connecting people to brands they love.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UX Designer — Design Systems

2021 – Present

Cargill | Minneapolis, MN

- Co-created and own the enterprise design system: now adopted by 13 product teams, managing scope, timelines, and cross-team rollout end to end.
- Direct point of contact for external brand partners including Sysco and Cargill Beef: coordinating on requirements, presenting recommendations, and keeping relationships strong.
- Internal champion for brand standards: building trust and buy-in across teams through consistent communication and follow-through.
- Turn complex brand requirements into clear guidelines and bring them directly to leadership: comfortable in the room and comfortable moving things forward.

General Manager

2018 – 2020

Family Restaurant | White Bear Lake, MN

- Led a full restaurant turnaround: owned the P&L, rebuilt the menu, launched an online presence, curated a branded apparel line, and put in a new POS system.
- Booked and ran ongoing brand partnership events: live music nights, craft brewery partnerships, and liquor brand activations, coordinating directly with reps, performers, and vendors.
- Managed every vendor relationship and supply order in the building: food, beverage, apparel, and operations, keeping accounts tight and spend on budget.

General Manager

2016 – 2018

Brewhouse South | Cool Springs, TN

- Ran full daily operations of a high-volume Nashville-area restaurant: staff, vendors, inventory, and guest relationships in a fast-paced market.

Sales Associate — Computers & Technology

2010 – 2014

Best Buy | White Bear Lake, MN

- Promoted from cashier to computer sales after one year: built real rapport with customers and matched them with the right products every time.
- Built a consultative approach from the sales floor up: listening first, then finding the right fit.

EDUCATION

UX Design Certificate

2020 – 2021

Prime Digital Academy

A.A.S., Audio Engineering & Production

Institute of Production and Recording